Yi Lu
Associate Professor and Chair of the Mathematics and Computer Science Department
Drew University, Madison NJ
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Education

Ph.D. in Statistics, The Ohio State University (Columbus, OH), August 2017
- Advisors: Radu Herbei and Sebastian Kurtek
- Dissertation: Function Registration from a Bayesian Perspective

M.S. in Statistics, The Ohio State University (Columbus, OH), May 2014

B.S. in Mathematics and B.A. in History, Mars Hill University (Mars Hill, NC), May 2011
- Honor: Summa Cum Laude

Research Interests

Functional data analysis, Bayesian methods and MCMC algorithms, computational statistics, simulation, curve registration, data visualization, applied statistics

Professional Experience

Drew University (Madison, New Jersey)
- Chair of the Department of Mathematics & Computer Science, Fall 2025 - Present
- Associate Professor, Department of Mathematics & Computer Science, Fall 2024 - Present
- Norma Gilbert Assistant Professor, Department of Mathematics & Computer Science, Fall 2017 - Summer 2024

iModules Software (Remote)
- Statistical Consultant, Summer 2019 - Spring 2020
  iModules is a higher-education alumni engagement platform with over 900 clients worldwide, including Ivy League institutions and large public university systems; it later became part of Anthology
  Project: Updated and developed metrics and models to measure alumni engagement in higher education institutions

The Ohio State University (Columbus, Ohio)
- Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Statistics, Fall 2012 - Spring 2017
- Consultant, Statistical Consulting Service (SCS), Spring 2016 - Summer 2017
- Graduate Research Assistant, Department of Statistics, Summer 2015
  Advisor: Radu Herbei (Supported in part by NSF DMS 1209142)
  Project: Compared different methods of parallel computing in executing the Metropolis-Hastings algorithm

The Progressive Corporation (Cleveland, Ohio)
- Research & Development Analyst (internship), Summer 2016
  Project: develop and validate regression models for calculating auto insurance rates

Teaching

Drew University

(* indicates first offering of the course at Drew)

- **Data Science Research Project** (DATA775)
  Fall 2026
- **Introduction to Statistics** (STAT117/STAT207)
  Fall 2026, Spring 2026, Fall 2025, Spring 2025, Fall 2024, Summer 2024, Spring 2024, Fall 2023, Fall 2022, Spring 2022, Summer 2020, Fall 2019, Summer 2019, Spring 2019, Fall 2018, Summer 2018, Spring 2018, Fall 2017
- **Modeling and Simulation** (DATA352/DATA551; crosslisted course for the M.S. Data Science program)
  Fall 2026, Spring 2025, Spring 2024, Spring 2023, Fall 2021, Spring 2021 (as independent study), Spring 2020*
- **Statistical Computing in R** (STAT120)
  Fall 2026, Summer 2026, Fall 2024, Fall 2023, Fall 2022, Fall 2021, Summer 2020, Fall 2019
- **Statistical Theory** (STAT350)
  Spring 2026, Spring 2024, Spring 2023, Spring 2022, Spring 2020, Spring 2018*
- **Probability** (MATH320)
  Fall 2025
- **Data Science: Introduction, History, and Case Studies** (DATA200)
  Fall 2024, Spring 2022, Spring 2018*
- **Applied Regression Analysis** (STAT335/DATA503; crosslisted course for the M.S. Data Science program)
  Fall 2022
- **Independent Studies in Mathematical Statistics** (MATH300)
  Spring 2021
- **Special Topics in Statistics: Bayesian Statistics** (STAT220)
  Spring 2021*
- **Computational Finance & Large Data Analysis** (FIN622; course for the M.S. Finance program)
  Spring 2019*
- **Data Visualization** (DATA251)
  Fall 2018*

The Ohio State University

- **Introduction to Mathematical Statistics** (STAT4201)
  Fall 2015
- **Statistics for Life Sciences** (STAT2480; recitation instructor)
  Spring 2015
- **Introduction to Mathematical Statistics II** (STAT4202; recitation instructor)
  Fall 2014
- **Introduction to Statistical Analysis** (STAT2450; recitation instructor)
  Fall 2014
- **Introduction to the Practice of Statistics** (STAT1450; recitation instructor)
  Summer 2014
- **Elementary Statistics** (STAT1350; recitation instructor)
  Spring 2014, Spring 2013, Fall 2012

Publications

(6) A. de Voogt, T. C. Koh, Y.Lu, "Low-Level Helicopter Flights: Safety and Operational Specificity," Safety (2026): 12(2), 48: https://doi.org/10.3390/safety12020048.

(5) A. de Voogt, Y.Lu, F. Pan, H. Zuckerman, "Abrupt maneuvers in General Aviation accidents," Safety Science (2025): Vol. 185: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ssci.2025.106785.

(4) Y. Lu, A. de Voogt, F. Gobet, "Dominance, Streakiness, and Non-random Patterns in the Game of N!àì," Journal of Expertise (2024): Vol. 6(4) & 7(1): https://www.journalofexpertise.org/articles/volume6_issue4_and_volume7_issue1/JoE_6_4_7_1_Lu_etal.html.

(3) A. de Voogt, A. Campos, Y. Lu "Amphibious Airplane Accidents: An Exploratory Analysis," Applied Sciences 13(22): 12224 (2023): https://doi.org/10.3390/app132212224.

(2) Y. Lu, R. Herbei, S. Kurtek, "Bayesian Function Registration with Random Truncation," Plos one 18.7 (2023): e0287734.

(1) Y. Lu, R. Herbei, S. Kurtek, "Bayesian Registration of Functions with a Gaussian Process Prior," Journal of Computational and Graphical Statistics 26.4 (2017): 894-904.

Advising Projects

(* indicates an Honors Thesis project)

- *Analyzing runners pace trajectory using functional data analysis methods*
  Emily Camlet; Drew Summer Science Institute (DSSI), Summer 2026
- *Comparative Analysis of the Effects of Mountaintop Removal Mining on Air and Water Quality In West Virginia*
  Arianna Mendez; Drew Summer Science Institute (DSSI), Summer 2024
- *Optimizing Water Usage and Revenue of Jordan's Agricultural Economy** link
  Muhammad Mir; MATH410: Specialized Honors in Mathematics I, Fall 2023; co-advisor with Jennifer Olmsted
- *Two Approaches to Statistical Research: Frequentist and Bayesian** link
  Jamie Connors; STAT300, Independent Study in Statistics, Fall 2022; MATH410: Specialized Honors in Mathematics I, Fall 2022; MATH411: Specialized Honors in Mathematics II, Spring 2023; co-advisor with Sarah Abramowitz
- *Fencing Data Analysis*
  Alex Goebel; Drew Summer Science Institute (DSSI), Summer 2022; STAT410: Specialized Honors in Statistics I, Fall 2022; STAT300: Independent Study in Statistics, Spring 2023

Honors Thesis Committee Member

- *Wombs as weapons: pronatalism as an instrument of authoritarianism under Trump* link
  Grace Remondelli (Political Science), Spring 2026
- *The role of intersectionality in predicting participation in and support for normative and nonnormative collective action* link
  Sumyyah Kadam (Psychology), Spring 2026
- *The Effects of ESG on the Energy Sector: A Cross-Regional Analysis of Stock Price Volatility* link
  Joseph Rojek (Economics), Spring 2025
- *Forecasting Financial Time Series: An Empirical Analysis of LSTM Model Performance Across Minute, Hourly, and Daily Time Frames* link
  Gabriel Dutra (Computer Science and Statistics), Spring 2023
- *Integrative taxonomy of New Jersey tardigrades* link
  Mehek Agrawal (Biology), Spring 2023
- *The Evolution of Trust: Understanding Prosocial Behavior in Multi-Agent Reinforcement Learning Systems* link
  David Nesterov-Rappoport (Computer Science), Spring 2022

Presentations

Conference Presentations

(3) *Bayesian Registration of Functions with a Gaussian Process Prior*, Joint Statistical Meetings (JSM), Chicago, August 2016

(2) *Bayesian Registration of Functions with a Gaussian Process Prior*, International Chinese Statistical Association (ICSA) Applied Statistics Symposium, Atlanta, June 2016

(1) *Answer in Two Decimal Places Accuracy: How 'Well' Are You Prepared for a Test*, The State of North Carolina Undergraduate Research and Creativity Symposium (SNCURCS), Meredith College, Fall 2010

Invited Talks and Workshops

(4) *Introduction to Decision Tree & Discussion on Data Analytics*, workshop lecture, Drew Summer College, July 2022

(3) *Quantitative Graphs: Principles of Effective Data Visualization*, Drew Faculty Workshop Series, May 2022

(2) *Bayesian Registration of Real-valued Functions*, Seminar Talk, Dr. Bing Zhang Department of Statistics, University of Kentucky, April 2022

(1) *Bayesian Registration of Functions*, Research Institute for Scientists Emeriti (RISE), Drew University, November 2018

Posters

(2) *Bayesian Registration of Functions*, Translational Data Analytics Forum, The Ohio State University, October 2015 and November 2016

(1) *Bayesian Registration of Functions*, Statistics and Biostatistics Graduate Student Poster Session, Department of Statistics, The Ohio State University, September 2015

Miscellaneous

(3) *The Magic Box: a Rating Engine for Auto Insurance Rate Comparisons* with Stewart Zellars, R&D research meeting, Progressive Cooperation, Cleveland, August 2016

(2) *A Tutorial on Majorize-Minimization (MM) algorithms* with Sophie Nguyen and Andrew Landgraf, Department of Statistics, The Ohio State University, Fall 2014

(1) *Temperature Trend of the past 118 Years in the United States* with Po-hsu Chen and Hui Yang, Department of Statistics, The Ohio State University, Fall 2013

Grants

(3) Core Innovation Fund for experimenting AI applications in Statistical Aviation Research (with Alex de Voogt), Drew University, Spring 2026

(2) Digital Humanities (DH) mini-grant for experimenting classroom technology in DATA251: data visualization, Drew University, Spring 2018

(1) Digital Humanities (DH) Faculty Development grant for supporting the co-teaching of DATA251: data visualization (with Lee Arnold), Drew University, Spring 2018

Awards

(7) Applied Statistics Symposium Student Travel Award (for contributed paper), International Chinese Statistical Association (ICSA), June 2016

(6) The Thomas E. & Jean D. Powers Award for Outstanding Teaching Associate, Department of Statistics, The Ohio State University, May 2015

(5) University Fellowship, The Ohio State University, 2011 - 2012

(4) Chair's Fellowship, The Ohio State University, March 2011

(3) Robert W. Sledge Fellowship, Alpha Chi National College Honor Society, April 2011

(2) Best Undergraduate Paper Award, University of North Carolina at Charlotte, April 2011

(1) Presidential Scholarship and Grayson Scholarship, Mars Hill University, 2007 - 2011

Services

Department

Chair of the Mathematics and Computer Science Department, Fall 2025 - Present

Coordinator of Statistics Instruction, Spring 2023 - Fall 2025

University

Institutional Review Board (IRB), Fall 2021 to Summer 2025
University Survey Working Group (initialized by the Office of Institutional Research), Fall 2021 to Spring 2023
Global Education Faculty Advisory Committee (GEFAC), Spring 2021 to Summer 2022
Academic Computing Advisory Committee (ACAC), Fall 2018 to Fall 2020
Statistical Software Discussion Group, Spring 2018
Judge, Fair for Emerging Researchers, March 2018

Professional

Article reviews: Annals of Applied Statistics (June 2022), Bayesian Analysis (May 2022), Journal of Statistic Education (June 2020, April 2018), Technometrics (October 2019)

References

Available upon request.